

Make Service-Business SEO Convert Better Than Paid Ads

Build an organic-search presence that **pre-sells** the caller — so the leads who reach you already trust you and close at a materially higher rate than paid-ad clicks. Distilled from Anastasiia Schwab (Total Home Rescue) on *Unscripted Small Business*.

Objective

Turn your website into a "read-then-call" funnel: education + trust content that answers the exact fears a customer has before they dial, so SEO callers arrive convinced. Ana measures **~30% close on SEO callers vs ~20% on paid** — because organic visitors "come prepared."

Key Steps

1. **Publish the "digital soapbox" content** — answer the exact questions a worried customer Googles (Is this dangerous? Will insurance cover it? What do I do first?). This is what pre-sells the call.
2. **Build a real service page per service × city** you cover (e.g. mold removal, water-damage repair, rebuild × each location) so search intent matches a page. *(Ana runs these across her site.)*
3. **Put trust signals on every page** — reviews, credentials, before/after, and your strongest promise ("you pay \$0 out of pocket — we fight the insurance company"). The reader should be convinced before they call.
4. **Run Google Local Services Ads alongside SEO**, not instead of it — capture bottom-funnel searchers now while the organic content compounds. *(inferred execution of the paid layer she named.)*
5. **Track close rate by source**. Tag SEO vs paid leads and compare conversion — proving SEO's higher ROI is how you justify shifting budget toward it.
6. **Add a paid referral channel** so SEO isn't your only inbound — pay trade partners (plumbers, HVAC, property managers) 10–35% per qualified lead.
7. **Give it runway**. Ana saw ~2 leads/week after ~2 months. Treat SEO as a compounding asset, not an on/off switch like ads.

Cautionary Notes

- Don't treat SEO like paid ads — it compounds over months; killing it early wastes the runway.
- Thin, generic pages won't pre-sell; if the page doesn't build trust, the "prepared caller" edge disappears.
- No source tracking = you can't prove SEO beats paid, and you'll underfund the better channel.
- More leads ≠ more jobs — chasing volume over fit fills the pipe with the wrong customers.

Tips for Efficiency

- Interview your own owner/techs for the content — the real answers to customer fears are already in their heads.
- Turn your best sales line into a headline everywhere ("you pay \$0 — we fight the insurer").
- Template the service + location pages: build one, clone per city.
- Layer LSA + SEO so you capture demand today and compound it for tomorrow.

Source: Anastasiia Schwab, Total Home Rescue — on *Unscripted Small Business*, she found organic-search leads convert far better than paid because they "come prepared" (read the site, already trust the authority), getting ~2 leads/week from ~2 months of website SEO.